

C4 Summer 2026
Final report
Team C2
Project Title: You(th) Are Here

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Use of AI tools

Portions of this project were reviewed and edited with the assistance of an artificial intelligence (AI) writing tool. The AI was used to help with wording, grammar, and clarity. All ideas, analysis, and final decisions about content, structure, and conclusions are our own

Project Statement:

Project Purpose:

The purpose of this project is to reduce the information gap faced by people experiencing homelessness with cognitive, learning, developmental, mental health, and sensory disabilities by designing semi-permanent, easy-to-read postings and information sheets that make shelter and support information easier to find, understand, and use in real time.

Goals:

1. Deliver information in accessible formats that match the communication needs of people with cognitive, learning, developmental, mental health, and sensory disabilities, so they do not have to rely only on dense text or complex verbal instructions.
2. Have the information sheets adopted and regularly used by community partners who support people experiencing homelessness with disabilities
3. Promote autonomy, and help people with disabilities feel more confident navigating the shelter and its services independently

Problem:

People experiencing homelessness with disabilities who use temporary and transitional support spaces often cannot reliably get clear, accurate, and accessible information about what services exist, which options actually meet their needs, and how to access them. This conclusion is supported by municipal data, human rights reporting, and recent news and advocacy showing that shelters are often not truly accessible or navigable, and that information about accessibility and available supports is incomplete or hard to find (Canadian Human Rights Commission, 2024; City of Toronto, 2025; Employment and Social Development Canada, 2023; Piercey, 2025)

Need:

People experiencing homelessness with disabilities often cannot easily find or understand clear, accessible information about what services exist, which options fit their needs, and how to use them. This information gap makes shelters harder to navigate and can stop people from accessing supports they are actually eligible for. There is a need for simple, easy-to-read information tools that present key shelter and support details in formats with cognitive and learning disabilities that can be used.

Scope:

In scope

The scope of this project is limited to improving information accessibility for youth with cognitive and learning disabilities, with the information sheet also supporting neurodivergent users, people with low literacy, and some ESL speakers. The delivery of this project focuses specifically on the Youth Services Bureau (YSB) Downtown Drop-In in Ottawa. For now, the

information sheet will be developed only for indoor use, displayed in a semi-permanent wall-mounted holder and supported by a basic digitally accessible version (for example, a PDF or page linked by QR code).

Out of Scope

- Disability groups outside the primary focus, such as people with mobility disabilities, people who are blind, and other disability types beyond cognitive, learning, developmental, mental health, and sensory information-processing needs.
- Outdoor or take-home information materials (for example, physical brochure-style handouts), which are not being developed at this stage and may only be explored after C4 if team members choose to continue the project.
- Age groups not served by YSB, and service locations that are not part of YSB.

An exception may apply for the mapping component, which can include links to external services and resources that complement YSB's support.

Stakeholders:

The following are people and groups who are affected by the implementation of our project, people who use/impacted by the info sheet.

- YSB
- People with cognitive and learning disabilities at YSB
- Frontline YSB staff
- City of Ottawa services related to youth, housing and homelessness
- Donors who support YSB services

Project: You(th) Are Here

What is our project about?

- It is an information accessibility project developed in collaboration with YSB to improve how services and resources are communicated. The project centers on an accessible information sheet that uses clear language, simple organization, and reduced visual clutter to make information easier to understand. It is designed to be both informative and welcoming, with particular attention to youth with cognitive, learning, and other support needs.
- The first component is an information sheet that presents important on-site information, services, and supports in a clear and accessible format. On the back, the sheet includes a map and a QR code that links users to a digital version of the map for easier reference and navigation. Below we have included images of the design template to illustrate how they look in Figure 1.1 and 1.2.

Why information sheets?

- As outlined in the problem statement: People experiencing homelessness with disabilities who use temporary and transitional support spaces often cannot reliably get clear, accurate, and accessible information about what services exist, which options actually meet their needs, and how to access them. By developing our information sheets, we aim to reduce this gap by presenting services and resources in a clear, accessible, and easy to navigate format that supports users in understanding what's available to them.

Who is it for?

- Our current design is intended for the Youth Services Bureau's Downtown Drop-In location, but it is not limited to this setting. The information system can be customized and tailored to the needs of other partners and contexts. For example, it could be adapted for transitional housing providers such as BetterStreet, or redesigned as an information sheet focused on safety for York University Community Safety.
- The current design of our project is intended for all people who use the YSB Downtown Drop-In. Staff can use the information sheet to point out and explain services, and youth can use it independently to see what supports are available and where to go next.

Where will it be placed?

- The information sheets can be accessed in both physical and digital formats. They may be displayed in semi-permanent wall holders, placed on tabletops, opened as digital PDFs on mobile devices and computers, or integrated into a community partner's webpage.

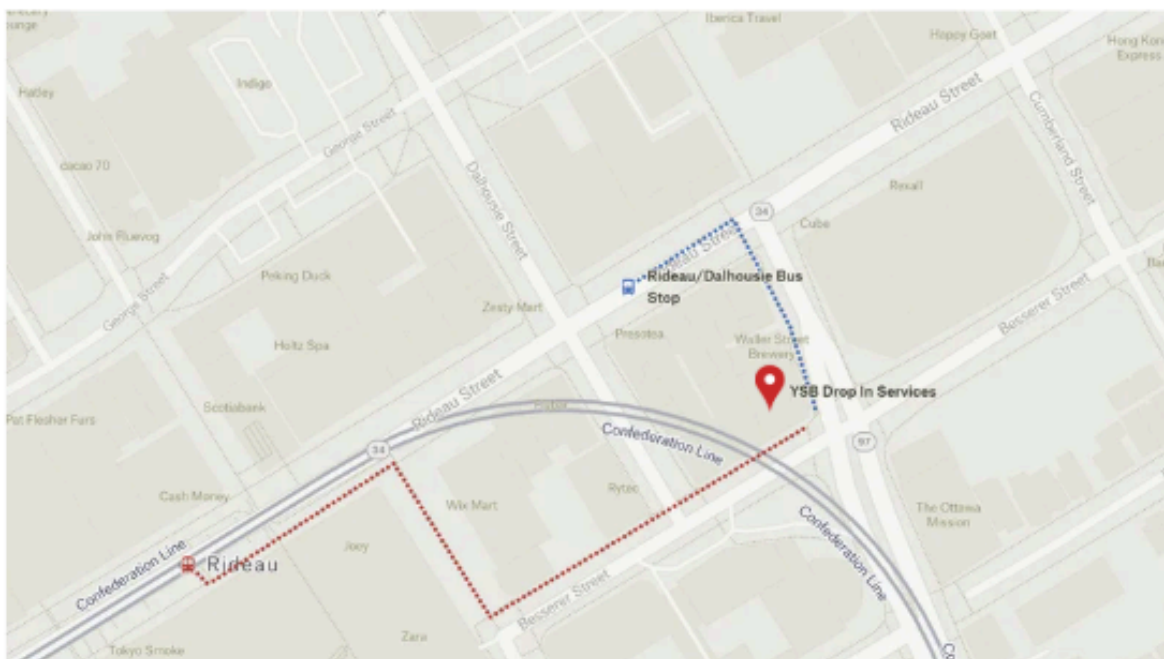
How This Project Was Developed: Methods and Tools

- We had used a combination of accessibility resources to help develop our information sheets and mapping tools. Such as AODA Information and Communications Standards, CharityComms, Ontario Regulation 191/11 (Integrated Accessibility Standards Regulation).
- Primary software tools we used to develop the info sheets and mapping:
 - <https://felt.com/>
 - <https://www.canva.com/>
 - <https://www.google.com/maps>

Figure 1.1 Front page Information Sheet

 Access Point QR code can go here	
 YSB Downtown Drop-In A space for youth looking for support, safety, basic needs, or next steps.	What you can do here  Shower Available: _____  Laundry Available: _____  Food Available: _____  Clothing / Supplies Available: _____  Phone / Internet Available: _____  Housing Help Available: _____  Talk to staff Ask about support, referrals, or next steps.
 Need help right now?  If you feel unsafe: Go to: _____ Ask for: _____  Crisis support: Call: _____  Emergency: Call 911	
 Quick reminder This is an inclusive space. Ask questions anytime. Staff are here to help.	 Important contacts
Need information another way? Ask staff for help reading, finding a quieter space, or understanding next steps	

Figure 1.2 Map



Youth Services Bureau of Ottawa

We Are Here:



YSB Downtown Drop-In
147 Bessner Street

Getting here:

Line 1: Rideau Station



Bus stop: Rideau/Dalhousie



Buses



Project Justification:

We wanted to take a look into the partner that we chose and how they give out information to make our own process of eliminating on how we can enhance the system of accessible information they already have. From what we've gathered, YSB information sheets are mainly text based with a dense amount of information to communicate the guidelines and services that are provided. But with individuals who face a range of disabilities or have been diagnosed with mental health issues, remembering complex wording and verbal instructions might not be the best way to get a person to a place of informed consent. From our five why's miro board, we started to get to a concrete way to create a long lasting solution for homeless and unhoused individuals to receive clarity on where they need to go and important contacts they need to be referred to.

One point that was made when brainstorming was how individuals with disabilities have to move within separate housing systems such as health care, community supports such as drop ins, and emergency housing places. This allowed for us to question why there seemed to be a short term solution to accessible planning, and the funding cuts that are potentially set to take place which limits the opportunities to provide shelters to refugees and asylum seekers (Petz, 2025). This also connects to the site visit where it was mentioned that the staff at these sites have professional boundaries and are not required to be a parental figure. But if that's paired with the lack of clear information, it can leave someone unsure about what they are allowed to ask, what they are agreeing to and what support is available to them. For a first timer or newcomer entering the shelter system, this can be difficult because they are trying to find safety while also understanding the rules of the space, consent forms, referrals, language options, emergency supports and where they are expected to go next.

This helped us justify why our project should focus on making the existing information system easier to understand and easier to return to. YSB already has a wide range of services such as the Downtown Drop-In, housing and shelter supports, employment services, mental health services, crisis support and youth engagement programs. However, because these services are connected to different locations, phone numbers, schedules and eligibility needs, it can be hard for someone to process all of that information at once. This is why our information sheet focuses on key details first such as where the person is, what they can do there, who to contact, what to do if they feel unsafe and how to reach crisis support.

The design of the information sheet was informed by our accessible design research and the feedback we received from partners. We used plain language, larger text, icons, strong contrast and grouped sections so the sheet is not only relying on full paragraphs or verbal explanation. We also kept YSB's branding in mind by using consistent colours including black, white, azure blue and light grey. We also used Oswald Bold for titles and Lato Regular for body text. This was done so the sheet still feels connected to YSB while making the layout easier to scan and recognize. The bilingual format was also important because Ottawa is a bilingual city and we heard through site visit notes that language can affect whether someone fully understands their options. By placing French under the English text, the sheet gives people another way to follow the information in the language they feel more comfortable with.

YSB's feedback also helped us validate that the idea could realistically work. They confirmed that youth are given important information at check-in including informed consents and an agreement to reside that covers rights, responsibilities, curfew and substance use rules. They

also confirmed that both physical and digital formats would be beneficial, colour printing is accessible and reprinting updated letter-sized pages would not be a problem. This supported our decision to use a semi-permanent letter paper holder because it allows the information to stay visible while still being easy for staff to update when schedules, contacts or services change.

Our map idea was also shaped by this feedback. Instead of making a map that is too broad, we narrowed it into a wide map and a zoomed in map connected to the YSB Downtown Drop-In and nearby resources. This includes places such as drop-ins, libraries, hospitals, employment services and transit routes. The QR code connects the physical information sheet to the digital map which gives youth another way to access information, zoom in and filter what they need. This matters because not every person will use information in the same way. Having both a physical and digital option makes the project more flexible.

Through our partner feedback and design testing, we moved away from a broad system-wide idea and narrowed the project into something site-specific, updateable and realistic for YSB to continue using. Overall, our project ended up as three connected pieces: a semi-permanent letter paper holder, a key information sheet and a wide map with a zoomed in map. These choices were made because they are realistic for YSB to maintain, easier for staff to update and more useful for youth who may need information presented in a clearer and more visual way. The long-term value of this project is that it can act as a handoff tool that YSB or other partners could adapt to their own spaces. The template can be changed depending on the site, the services offered, the language needs and the surrounding resources. This allows the project to continue as a practical model for improving information, accessibility and autonomy beyond one version of the prototype.

Project Design Thinking

When we first explored possible solutions around homelessness and accessibility, we focused on how people experiencing homelessness with disabilities weren't getting the resources they needed and also how information for them is scarce, scattered, or difficult to navigate. At this stage, our ideas were still quite broad and not yet aligned with our strengths as a team. Some early concepts included trying to design reliable and affordable ramps, shower bars, or looking into how we can create a website/map with consolidated accessibility information that was easy to find. These were good solutions to think about for the problems identified, but they raised major concerns about feasibility within the limited time and our current skill sets, designing and testing a ramp, shower bars, or a fully developed website with consolidated information were not achievable goals. We did not have the engineering or technical background for mobility assistive hardware, nor the web development and mapping experience needed to build and maintain an online platform effectively.

After the initial presentation during week 1 where we got to engage with partners and the site visits, we got a clearer picture of some of their problems, as well as a better understanding of each other's skills and tools we can utilise effectively. Our team has members with significant design experience and interest, this aligned with one of the issues during our presentation where Michael from YSB indicated to us that they had information sheets that weren't ideal and could be made better. Based on this we started to focus on how we could redesign an information sheet that would contain information more clearly, reduce cognitive load, and make it easier for users to navigate.

The project is sustainable in the sense that staff can maintain and update the information themselves. The information sheets and postings are designed to be simple to edit in the pdf, which ensures that details can be updated quickly and accurately, allowing staff to update blank fields such as services, hours, contact details, room locations, or activities and reprinting as needed. The project is also relatively low in cost as it relies on standard pdf editing software, printing services and inexpensive file holders.

The design of our project isn't entirely something that is innovative but it is somewhat out-of-the-box in the context of posters and info sheets because it moves away from the standard text heavy info sheets and postings that are usually temporary and used for a short period of time. Instead, it focuses on semi-permanent postings that are easier to read for people with disabilities and are easy to update, with clearly defined sections that staff can edit or swap out without recreating the entire sheet.

When we were building and validating our info sheets for accessibility, we drew on several resources. We used the AODA Information and Communications Standards and Ontario Regulation 191/11 (Integrated Accessibility Standards Regulation) to understand the legal expectations around accessible information, and used CharityComms' core principles for accessible print design to guide our choices about layout, contrast, font size, and plain language. We also followed accessibility guidance built into Canva's design resources to help check colour contrast and readability while creating the final materials. In addition we also validated our decisions with our community partner by emailing questions and taking note of their feedback during the presentations.

It is important to note that we did not directly consult people with disabilities to review our materials, in order to respect course ethics requirements and avoid recruiting participants without formal approval. As a result, our design is informed by secondary sources, partner input, and accessibility guidelines rather than direct user testing.

How does our Project fit into Universal Design Principles?

- Equitable Use
 - Our information sheet is intended for everyone who uses the YSB Downtown Drop-In space, including youth and staff, rather than being a separate 'accessible' version for only one group. It applies universal design principles by using plain language, clear layout, icons, and strong visual hierarchy so that it is easier to use for many different people, especially youth with cognitive and learning disabilities, low literacy, or ESL backgrounds. At the same time, we recognize that some disability groups, such as people who rely on Braille or screen readers, would still need additional formats beyond this info sheet. At the same time, we recognize that some disability groups, such as people who rely on Braille or screen readers, would still need additional formats beyond this info sheet. We tested basic accessibility features on smartphones, focusing on text-to-speech tools for people with blindness or very low vision, and confirmed that our PDF can be read by these functions. However, this testing was limited, and we cannot guarantee consistent accessibility across all devices, platforms, or assistive technologies, so further work would be needed to develop and validate fully accessible Braille and other screen readers.
- Flexibility in Use

- Our design has flexibility in use: staff can use the sheet during conversations, while youth can read it on their own, photograph it, or access linked resources through the QR code
- Simple and Intuitive Use
 - The sheet is organized into simple, intuitive sections with plain language so that users can quickly understand what services exist, where to go, and what to do next
- Perceptible Information
 - Key information is presented through simple text, headings, icons, and a map, so that important details are perceptible to users with different literacy levels, language skills, and ways of processing information
- Low Physical Effort
 - The design of the readability is intended to be easy to read with little effort needed to scan and understand the information.
- Size and Space for Approach and Use
 - We considered size and placement so the information sheet can be approached and read by users who are standing or using mobility devices. By using a standard 8.5x11 letter-sized format, our info sheets fit most common frames and holders, and can be placed on walls, desks, or counters. This widely used format makes it easy to reposition the sheets as needed so they can fit almost anywhere in the space while remaining accessible to different users. This is still somewhat limited to the physical realities of the site, for instance, at YSB Downtown Drop-In, where wall space, furniture layout, and traffic flow may restrict exactly where the sheets can be mounted or displayed.
- Tolerance for error
 - The info sheets use simple language, clear grouping, and icons so key services and resources are harder to overlook, even when users skim or misread parts of the content. While users can still misread specific details like phone numbers or addresses, the layout reduces this risk by making those elements more prominent and easier to scan.

Refer back to Figures 1.1 and 1.2 to see how these principles are applied in our current design.

Ethics Statement

We wanted to include the ethics aspect of our ideas by providing accessible information in a welcoming and broken-down way. This meant not only focusing on one restricted age group, but also making sure the language used in our information sheet and wayfinding map was

compatible with the level of knowledge and understanding people may have. We also made a note that for the accessible wall mount sheets, we wanted to include both physical and digital choice so that people can decide on what they feel most comfortable to consent to when looking at the different services that were provided for them. For example, creating a QR code on the information sheet that transfers them to the same resources except on the device that either the site has for them to use or a device they have within their possession that they can feel safe using. If that were to occur, we need to look at the privacy concerns so this would mean that we would not ask to collect any information to be stored and later used or using the information they consented to giving our partner's site in a way that goes beyond the purpose of accessing services. The goal would be to make the information in a clear and easy to read way so that the individual has the autonomous decision to decline or accept the choice being made to give their information to the site that they go to.

In terms of our team values, we wanted to ensure that our process reflected respect, empathy, accountability, and a space for open communication. Since our project touches upon people who may already face barriers in the shelter system, we had to be careful not to design something that made assumptions about what people need or how they should use the information given. This meant thinking about whether the sheet and map would actually reduce confusion instead of adding another layer of work for the person using it. We also wanted the wording to feel supportive instead of judgemental, which is why reminders such as "staff are here to help" and "ask questions anytime" were included in the design.

We also conducted our work ethically by dividing tasks based on people's strengths and availability instead of expecting everyone to contribute in the exact same way at the exact same time. Some team members focused more on the design portion of the wall-mounted information sheet, different layout options and the wayfinding map. Others focused on research, writing, editing, organizing feedback and connecting the project back to accessibility and homelessness. Since we had different schedules, we used team communication to check in, share updates and make sure the work was still moving forward. This allowed us to respect each other's capacity while still making sure the final project was collaborative.

Our ethics of care also came through in how we handled research and feedback. We did not directly collect personal stories or private information from people experiencing homelessness because that would require stronger ethics approval and could place pressure on a vulnerable group. Instead, we used partner feedback, site visit notes, public research from articles and papers, and accessibility guidelines to inform our design. This helped us avoid asking sensitive questions or collecting data that was not needed for the project. When thinking about the QR code and digital map, we also considered that the purpose should be access to information, not tracking or storing someone's personal choices.

For the DEI lens, we did not want to only focus on one specific type of disability. We wanted the information sheet and map to be more inclusive for people with different physical, cognitive, sensory, developmental, mental health, language and learning needs. This is why our design uses plain language, larger text, icons, colour contrast, bilingual wording and clear

sections. The goal was not to make one perfect resource for everyone, because that would not be realistic, but to make the existing information more usable for a wider range of people. By giving people more than one way to access the same information, our project supports autonomy, accessibility and informed decision-making.

Connection to SDG Goals

When looking at the SDG goals, our team wanted to focus on the goals that were most relevant to our project instead of connecting our work to every goal in a general and biased way. On the SDG roadmap board, we dissected whether our project would have an indirect positive, direct positive, no impact, or indirect negative. This allowed us to create a narrow pathway on these specific goals that connected most clearly to homelessness, accessibility, and autonomy.

The SDGs that our ideas had the strongest connection to were no poverty, good health and well being, reduced inequalities, sustainable cities and communities, and peace, justice, and strong institutions. These goals were marked down as a direct positive because our project focuses on making shelter and support information easier to access for youth and adults experiencing homelessness with different types of disabilities. By creating a clear and well navigated information sheet that has icons that are associated with the text that is spaced for the individual reading to follow, and this is because we want to emphasize the idea that people should be able to understand important information without only relying on staff, verbal instructions, or long written resources. This especially connects to good health and well being because the information sheet includes crisis support, emergency information, mental health related supports, showers, meals, laundry, and housing help.

Sustainable cities and communities also relate strongly to our map because of the wayfinding map, which helps people understand what is available around them and how to get there by filtering out what routes to take based on the location that is a priority to get to. The map includes nearby services, transit routes, YSB locations, employment services, mental health services, hospitals and clinics. This makes the city and shelter system feel easier to navigate because the information is shown in a more visual and organized way. Peace, justice and strong institutions also connect to our project because clear information can support trust, informed consent and dignity. When someone understands the rules, contacts, services and next steps, they are in a better position to make choices for themselves.

At the same time, our project did not fully achieve every SDG impact because it does not create new shelter beds, solve funding issues, provide direct housing or remove the larger barriers that people with disabilities face in the shelter system. The QR code also has limits because not everyone will have a phone, data or feel comfortable using a digital option, which is why the physical information sheet is still important. To increase our SDG impact, the project would need to be tested with staff and service users so we can see if the layout is easy to understand, if the icons make sense and if the map includes the right resources. The project could also be expanded with more languages and a simple guide so other shelters or

drop-ins can adapt the same template to their own space, services and surrounding community resources.

Process of Completion

Roles	Assignee(s)	Responsibilities
Management Team	Shae-Lin, Esmaeel	Monitored project progression, facilitated team discussions, supervised task completion, and supported members with decision-making.
Research and Data Collection	Ilwad and Kuan	collecting and sharing information from note taking, relay observations to team members, drafting sections of the reports, and finding other community resources relevant to accessibility and homelessness.
Notetakers/Writers	All team members	Recorded partner/presentation feedback, drafted project materials including team charter, research summaries, problem statements, and presentation content.
Editors/Organizers	All team members	Reviewed and revised written components for consistency, clarification, and adherence to project requirements. Organized contributions into shared project files/documents.
Session Chair	Rotated amongst members	Conducted reviews of

		project objectives, tasks, and deadlines, with members and encouraged team communication.
Presentation Speakers	Kuan, Spence, Estelle	Communicate slide presentation ideas to partners, asking for feedback and follow up questions to the partners to incorporate into our ideas

Interdisciplinary Reflection

As we developed our response to the problem, our current solution naturally shifted toward a design-centred approach, with launchpad members like Estelle, Daphne, and Spence having previous experience and courses that aligned with visual designs, user experience and communication. It was in addition to Michael's feedback at YSB that pushed this even further when he stated information sheets/boards at YSB weren't as optimal and could be made better, which encouraged our team to focus even more on redesigning accessible, visually clear information materials. In response to those issues at YSB, the designated design-centred members looked into how information would be seen and understood in the space, experimenting with different layouts, icons, colour, etc.

Other team members like Kuan and Ilwad were stronger on the more technical and analytical aspects of the project, such as working through research materials, organizing findings and drafting sections of the reports. They also played important roles in collecting and sharing information from note taking during partner feedback, helping the rest of the team stay up to date on what needed to be revised or developed next. Members such as Kuan and Estelle, who were more comfortable with public speaking and presentations, took more initiative sharing the team's work with community partners and supported discussions among the launchpad team when the management were unavailable. They helped frame our design decisions, collected feedback on what was or was not working, and then brought those insights back to the group, which helped the team to better align our project towards our community partner needs.

It is also important to note that some of these roles aren't entirely fixed or tied to the person's strength, there were moments where everyone was involved in research, working on the reports, or even on DEMO day where majority of the members were involved in presenting our ideas as there were multiple people checking in on our project simultaneously. It is just that certain members tended to take the lead in particular areas more often, based on their prior experience and comfort levels.

Some early challenges we experienced were tied to our initial solution ideas. Several of these concepts required skills we did not have as a team, such as advanced engineering for building ramps or building shower handles, or specialized knowledge of GIS-based mapping. Because of the expertise required and our limited time at C4, it was nearly impossible to fully develop some of these solutions. Hence why our team went for something more design centered as the majority of the team was more confident working within those areas. For the mapping component, Kuan's prior experience with certain softwares gave us enough confidence to include a more modest and simple integrated map.

In this way, our project became a multidisciplinary effort that brought together design, research, technical thinking, and communication. Design-focused members led the visual and UX work, research-oriented members organized evidence and feasibility, and strong communicators connected our ideas back to YSB through presentations and feedback.

1-minute Project Video

<https://vimeo.com/1201282969?share=copy&fl=sv&fe=ci>

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Lavoie, J. (2025, September 23). Toronto has a chance to do better: Advocates want city to make shelters more accessible for people with disabilities, especially before winter hits. CTV News Toronto.

<https://www.ctvnews.ca/toronto/local/article/toronto-has-a-chance-to-do-better-advocates-want-city-to-make-shelters-more-accessible-for-people-with-disabilities-especially-before-winter-hits/>

Appendix

Additional Designs

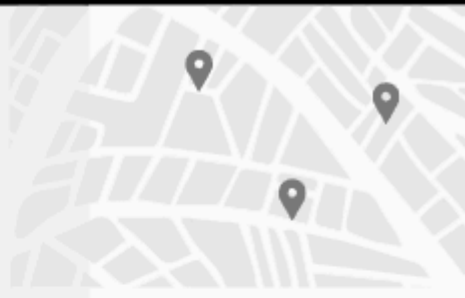


YSB Downtown Drop-In

Halte-accueil centre-ville BSJ

147 Besserer St, Ottawa, ON

613-241-7788



Available Services / Services disponibles



Housing
Hébergement



Phone
Téléphone



Internet



Showers
Douches



Laundry
Lavage



Meals & Pantry
Repas et banque
alimentaire

Spectrum LGBTQ – Mondays from 5 p.m.-7 p.m.

Ontario Works – every Thursday from 1:00 – 3:00 p.m.

ODSP Liaison – first Wednesday of the month from 12:00 p.m.-4:00 p.m.

The Royal – Monday from 12:00 – 2:00 p.m.

Curfew? Substance rules?

This is an inclusive space.

Ask questions anytime.

Staff are here to help.

Ceci est un espace inclusif.

N'hésitez pas à poser des questions.

Le personnel est là pour vous aider.



24/7

Crisis Line
Ligne de crise

613-260-2360

Available Accessibility Resources



Type of Disability

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Type of Disability

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Type of Disability

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____



Type of Disability

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Type of Disability

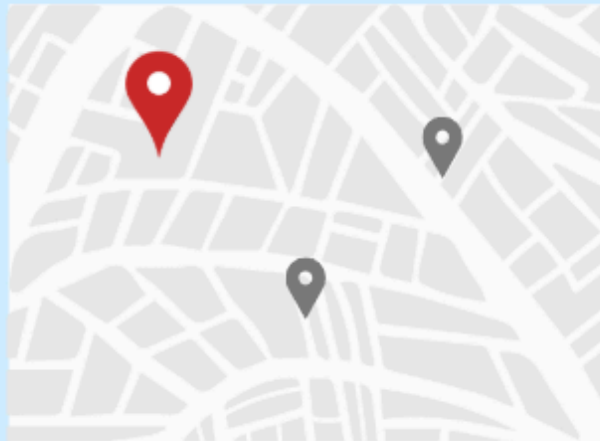
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Youth Services Bureau of Ottawa

You Are Here:



YSB Downtown Drop-In
147 Besserer Street



Who We Are

We are a space for youth looking for:

- support
- safety
- basic needs
- guidance

Available Support Resources

- In-Person Support Staff
- Crisis Contact Information

What We Offer

- Showers
- Food
- Clothing
- Phone/Internet Services
- Housing Help

Core Service Rules/Guidelines:

Learn more at:



Youth
Services
Jeunesse

www.reallygreatsite.com.

Additional Information regarding mapping and Wayfinding- Kuan

Key takeaways From the Resna Research Below

Memory and spatial challenges: People with certain cognitive conditions (e.g., dementia, TBI, developmental disabilities) may have short-term and/or long-term memory difficulties that affect remembering routes, destinations, or where they currently are.

Disorientation and getting lost: Research on dementia and MCI consistently shows impaired spatial navigation and a higher risk of becoming disoriented in community settings.

Fear, stress, and anxiety: Qualitative reports and the RESNA paper's interview show that fear of getting lost and of not being able to get help can create significant stress when moving through urban environments

The paper also suggests wayfinding tools to let users choose between “survey” (bird’s-eye) maps and “egocentric” (turn-by-turn) views, since different people benefit from different spatial representations.

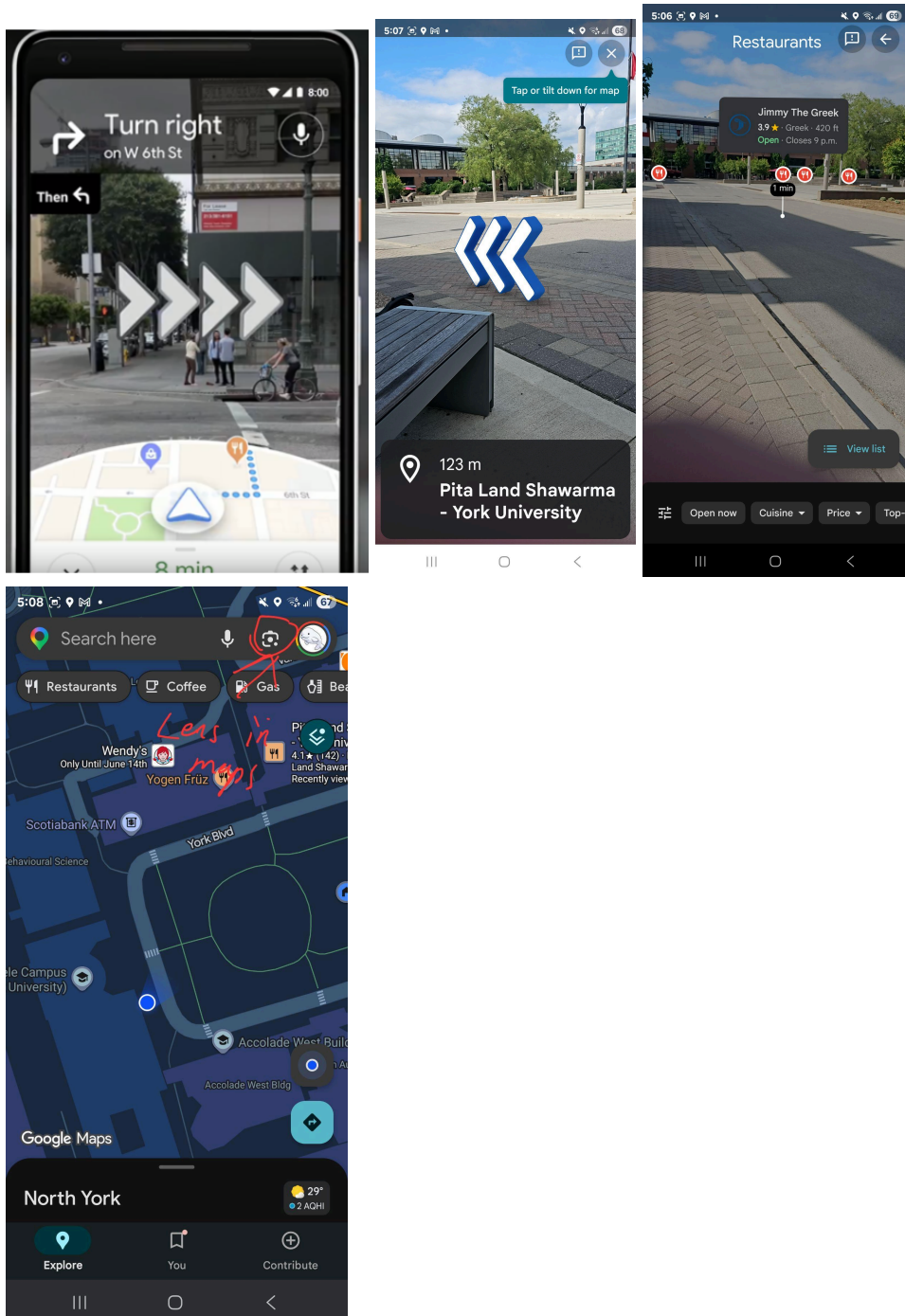
<https://www.resna.org/sites/default/files/conference/2018/cognitive/Khanuja.html>

Based on this research our map may not be sufficient for people with disabilities, it is better to compliment a top down view map with something like what google maps has called “[lens in maps](#)”

<https://support.google.com/maps/answer/9332056?hl=en&co=GENIE.Platform%3DAndroid>

However this feature is only available in select locations, and the partners we are working with in Ottawa are not listed as a support city. A team member also tried and they could not find the feature on google maps, this may be a problem of incompatible devices or a city not supported. Current cities supported in Canada are: Vancouver, Toronto and Montreal.

Examples of Lens in Maps:



From my personal experience it provides an easy way to navigate without too much information on the screen. This is an ideal solution for people trying to navigate with cognitive and learning disabilities. However there is no way to personalise this tool and edit it like a conventional map with your own pins and labels. There is also no other widely available tool to create something of this nature unless a mapping company is hired to create a custom path/route. The only way is to incorporate this is using your own mapping tool in combination with google maps, lens in maps, which again is not available in every device and/or city.

This is something I would like to keep an eye out for more tools or a future prospect for google maps to make more widely available.